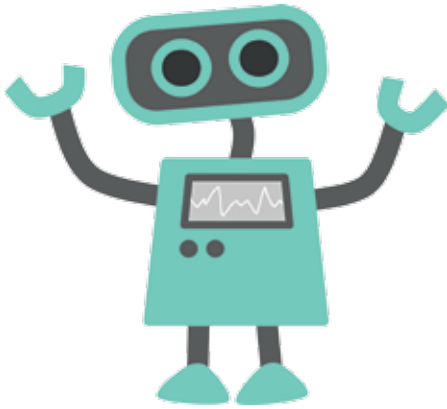


in a world where all cars communicate with each other. They calculate the optimum route and speed to reach their destinations. Your workstation boots up as soon as you enter and you sit down to work on your current project – a robot that helps you make more robots. Seems like a stretch?



Robots have infiltrated every aspect of our lives and we are surrounded by them without even realizing this.

Back to 2017, we are slowly but steadily moving towards a completely automated future. Take a look around you, technology giants are working hard to make self-driving cars a reality, and they are really, really close. New innovations and breakthrough technologies are coming out almost everyday. If you had told someone 30 years ago that they could see and talk to anyone across the globe in realtime, they

probably wouldn't have believed you, in fact maybe even calling you just another nutjob. Nonetheless, the future is here now and the magical thing that is changing our lives currently are 'robots'.

What is a machine and what is a robot? Is my toaster a robot too?

According to Wikipedia, a machine is any mechanical device that “changes the direction or magnitude of a force”. Machines can be divided into six simple categories:

- | | |
|-----------|-------------------|
| 1. Lever | 2. Wheel and axle |
| 3. Pulley | 4. Inclined plane |
| 5. Wedge | 6. Screw |

A machine can be any of these six or a combination of two or more that performs a certain task.

A robot is, well, much more complicated. It can be a combination of machines such that:

- It can be programmed
- Interacts with the environment and takes in 'perceptions'